

A

Formation

We form compound nouns by putting two words together (or three) to create a new idea. Compound nouns are very common in English.

Ice hockey is a game of hockey played on ice.

Public transport is transport that can be used by the public.

A **campsite** is a **site** for camping. [a place used for a special purpose]

A **babysitter** is someone who looks after young children when their parents go out.

Income tax is money you pay to the government out of your **income** [the total amount of money you receive every year from your work and other places].

Your **mother tongue** is the first language you learn as a child.

A **travel agent** is someone whose job is to make travel arrangements for you.

A **film-maker** is someone who makes films for the cinema or television.

A **full stop** is a punctuation mark at the end of a sentence.

A **haircut** is the act of cutting someone's hair, e.g. *That boy needs a haircut.*



B

One word or two?

Some compound nouns are written as one word, e.g. **wheelchair**; a few are written with a hyphen, e.g. **T-shirt**; many are written as two words, e.g. **credit card**, **bus stop**. Use a dictionary to check if necessary.

C

Pronunciation

The main stress is usually on the first part, e.g. **'ha**ircut or **'in**come tax, but sometimes it is on the second part, e.g. public **tr**ansport, full **s**top. Use a dictionary to check if necessary.

D

Forming new compounds

One part of a compound often forms the basis for a number of compound nouns.

airport e.g. Heathrow

airline e.g. Lufthansa, KLM

aircraft e.g. Airbus A380

bus driver

bus stop

bus station

ID card (identity card)

credit card

birthday card